

because what you see is what others will as well—so make sure to keep the little Preview checkbox ticked, so you can see what’s happening in your actual image *before* you click OK!

However, what do you do if you’re working with a dark background?

Inner Shadow

When working with dark backgrounds, it’s obviously not going to be possible to give a layer an outer (drop) shadow, simply because it will not be seen. In such cases you should use the Inner Shadow option. This creates the shadow inside the selected layer, and thus gives it the effect of being cut into the background instead of being placed upon it, as with the Drop Shadow effect.

With both shadow effects, you can select various parameters of the effect, such as the opacity of the layer, its shadow, the height / depth of the layer casting the shadow, etc. As we mentioned earlier,



As you can see here, the text was being hidden by a non-contrasting background. Not anymore!



The Inner Shadow is used for dark backgrounds where the Drop Shadow effect would not be visible